

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

GUIDELINE MANUAL

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Guideline: 608.05 Tire Fires

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safety of the incident scene. Protection of the fire crew's safety will be addressed continuously. RIC crews will be established per the Rapid Intervention Crew procedure. Buildings, equipment, and utilities in the proximity of the fire will need to be protected. Command needs to determine the amount of fuel actively burning and the total amount of fuel available. Estimate the rate of spread to determine what will be allowed to burn and where fire breaks will be cut through the pile.

Creating firebreaks in a large tire pile is a long and time-consuming process. It can be accomplished with heavy machinery and front-end loaders. Use of City Equipment at Emergency Scenes procedure will allow Command to implement the process.

STRATEGY

Successful options for fighting a tire fire have been employed individually and in many cases in combination with one another. Reduced to the lowest common denominator these options are:

1. Burn it
2. Drown it

BURN IT

Letting a tire pile burn has its merits. Soil and water pollution may be drastically reduced when many of the products of combustion go up in smoke. The cleanup costs can be reduced when compared to other options.

A precedent for the burn it strategy appears in fire responses to chemical fires. Adding water to fires or hazardous materials that react to water could exacerbate the emergency.

Importantly the fire service must manage and control the burn. Protecting exposures and separating tires from the burn area will continue to be a tactical priority.

DROWN IT

Water, foam and additives have their own place as an option. The Drown It Strategy is best employed with forethought and careful pre-planning. Knowing in advance the topography and exposure hazards to water sources will be critical.

Drawbacks to the drown it strategy include:

1. An increase in the toxic air emissions as the fire is cooled causing the combustion process to slow down.

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2. An inordinate amount of water run-off combined with pyrolitic oil will be the result of trying to drown out a fire.
3. Effectiveness of working lines applied to a tire fire is questionable. Handlines alone cannot reach the interior spaces of a tire fire.

The use of working lines on chunk and chipped tires can be effective when used in a fog application. Separating the inventory from the burn area is important to the control and extinguishment of chipped and chunk tire materials.

The use of foam would best be employed on small tire fires or when the fire is in the incipient stage. Pulling a larger tire pile apart with heavy machinery and applying foam would be a prudent use of the product. Foam should only be employed as part of a predetermined strategy.

CLEAN-UP AND OVERHAUL

Unlike traditional structural fires or wildland fires clean up on tire fires will probably be turned over to an appropriate environmental protection agency.

Hazards to personnel exist long after the fire is out. Toxicity levels of tire fire sites suggest high concentrations of contaminants. Flying ash and contaminated soil blown around the site may increase your exposure risks.

Command Concerns Scrap tire fires can potentially last days, weeks, or months. Combined with the fact they are highly toxic and dangerous Command must consider or address the following concerns:

- Emergency Operations Center
- Emergency Operations Plan
- Accountability
- Rapid Intervention Crews
- Safety
- Environmental
- Evacuation
- Public Information
- Welfare
- Police Liaison
- Rehabilitation
- Staging
- Hazardous Materials
- Decontamination
- Air Operations

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- Water Department Communications Hazardous Materials Incidents
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The purpose of the air management guideline is to improve firefighter safety by describing how we will manage the air in our SCBA cylinders while operating in the hazard zone at an incident.

HISTORY

The clear majority of the structure fires in Calimesa are single or multi-family residential occupancies. Our typical strategy is an aggressive offensive fire fight to achieve the tactical priorities. Generally we can search these structures quickly, put out the fire, and exit the hazard zone without having to give much thought to air management. There are usually multiple points of egress close by should a rapid retreat to the exterior become necessary.

A serious safety issue evolves when we apply these same residential air management tactics to larger, more complex structures such as commercial buildings. Air management becomes critically important in incidents involving commercial buildings because firefighting forces usually have greater travel distances and must navigate obstacles to reach the fire. Additionally there are limited points of egress available for rapid retreat to the exterior if conditions change.

The increased fire load inside the structure and complex interior building arrangements challenge us as we attempt to exit the building, as the line you enter on is also the exit path. Locating the fire, extinguishment, and exiting the hazard zone requires more time and air consumption. The danger of getting lost or entangled on the way out increases as well so it's critical to insure firefighters exit the hazard zone with an emergency reserve of air.

After review of Phoenix Firefighter Bret Tarver's death at the Southwest Supermarket fire in 2001 numerous training exercises were conducted to determine the causes and possible solutions for firefighter emergencies encountered during commercial and/or "big box" fires. It was discovered that once the low air alarm of an SCBA is activated a firefighter can crawl approximately 150 feet until their air supply is exhausted. For this reason the maximum distance a crew will enter any building is 150 feet. If the fire is located further than 150 feet command will assign additional companies to attack from a closer access point.

RULE OF AIR MANAGEMENT

All members utilizing an SCBA in the hazard zone of an incident shall monitor the amount of air in their SCBA cylinder as well as their rate of air consumption to exit the hazard zone prior to the low air alarm activation of the SCBA.

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Just as ocean divers are trained to surface with an emergency reserve of air firefighters shall exit the hazard zone of an incident with an emergency reserve of air. It is critical that firefighters understand that the initial 75% of the air supply is the "working and exiting air". This includes air utilized for gaining access, working toward the tactical objectives, and exiting the hazard zone.

The remaining 25% of the air supply is the emergency reserve to be used only in the event an emergency occurs while exiting such as becoming lost, trapped, or entangled upon exiting the hazard zone.

Company officers shall frequently assess their crew's air consumption rates and decide the crew's exit time based on the individual with the greatest assumed air consumption rate. It is the individual firefighter's responsibility to continually assess and report his/her air consumption to his/her company officer.

STRATEGIC LEVEL AIR MANAGEMENT

The incident commander shall consider air management a critical fire ground factor when evaluating the risk management profile of a building, performing size-up, and determining the strategy. Command will assist companies in air management by:

- Controlling position and function of crews in the hazard zone (accountability)
- Maintaining an awareness of how long crews have been working (elapsed time notifications)
- Insuring adequate resources are on-scene to maintain a tactical reserve (layered resources)
- Assigning companies to multiple points of egress (150' rule)
- Relieving and rotating operating crews as needed (recycle/rehab/on-deck).

Command should seek "air status" of companies in the hazard zone through regular Personnel Accountability Reports (PAR reports). Benchmarks for PAR reports are 10-minute elapsed time on air, all clear, fire control and lost stopped.

To enhance firefighter safety command shall maintain a tactical reserve of companies' on-scene. An extra company should be assigned to a forward "on-deck" position within each sector to facilitate rapid relief and replacement of companies that are exiting the hazard zone. The forward or "on-deck" company will also be ready and available to rapidly deploy for firefighter rescue in the event the need arises (RIC).

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TACTICAL LEVEL AIR MANAGEMENT

A Company Officer should be placed in each group to insure the actions of crews working within the group accomplish the tactical objectives. The responsibilities of the Company Officer include:

- Performing size-up and determining tactics
- Accountability of members operating in the group (passports, hose lines)
- Requesting resources and maintaining a reserve of "on-deck" companies
- Tracking operating crews time on air
- Managing rotation of crews and providing relief either through recycle or rehab
- Providing command with frequent PAR reports.

TASK LEVEL AIR MANAGEMENT

Every member shall check their SCBA at the beginning of the shift to ensure that they have a full air cylinder and the pass device works. On the fire ground every firefighter is responsible for managing their own air supply and frequently communicating the status of their air supply to the company officer. In turn the company officer will give frequent progress reports including air status to command or the sector officer.

Prior to entry into the hazard zone the company officer will brief his/her crew on the plan for achieving the tactical objectives including exiting the hazard zone together. This insures the crew has a "round trip ticket" into and out of the hazard zone safely. All members shall maintain constant contact with the hose line and manage the line so that excessive hose is not brought into the structure. This will assist in reducing travel time while following the hose line out of the building when air management is the most critical. All members of the crew will exit prior to the low air alarm sounding on the SCBA.

AIR EMERGENCIES

An air emergency is defined as "anytime the breathing apparatus being used cannot deliver air to the user as designed; whether by mechanical failure or if the individual has consumed the air supply beyond the designed work cycle or an individual becomes lost or trapped within an IDHL environment regardless of air supply".

Activation of the low-air warning (vibe alert/whistle) is an immediate action item for the individual and the crew involved. Immediate action is described as notifying command of low-air alarm activation and immediately exiting the IDLH atmosphere intact as a crew and notifying command that you are out with a PAR after exiting. If a crewmember is unable to exit due to being lost, trapped or injured an immediate MAYDAY shall be called. Furthermore when remaining air supply in the SCBA cylinder reaches the 18% to 15% range a MAYDAY should be called if personnel are still inside an IDLH atmosphere and will be unable to exit within 5 minutes.

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In a situation that is not an urgent MAYDAY situation such as low air activation while still inside an IDLH atmosphere but near an exit and able to reach the exterior safely the notification from the crew to command will trigger a set of questions from the Incident Commander to the crew. The Incident Commander should determine:

- Where are you in the building?
- Are you able to exit safely?
- Notify me with a PAR when you are clear of the building

The Incident Commander will then notify the sector officer and/or RIC crew stating, "I have a crew/individual that has a low air activation going off and exiting the - - - side of the building. This will give personnel that could affect a rescue a heads up that there could be a possible emergency and rescue personnel can position themselves accordingly.

After notification of a low-air alert the Incident Commander will begin monitoring time elapsed since receiving notification of the low air alarm. If the individual and crew involved have not exited the building within a five or ten-minute time frame then command would react accordingly to the circumstances of the event. This may include emergency traffic or a MAYDAY declaration and deployment of a RIC crew based upon experience or circumstances that the Incident Commander is presented with.

Summary of Key Points

- Always start with a full SCBA cylinder
- Have a Round trip ticket plan (entry and exit plan)
- Maximum interior distance is 150 feet
- No gated Y's inside building
- Everyone is responsible for their own air management
- Captain's monitor crews air supply
- Crew reports air supply to Captain
- Division officers monitor companies in their groups
- Command communicates with divisions and groups and insures adequate resources are on-scene
- Everyone exits and is out of the hazard zone prior to low air alarm activation 75% - 25% rule.
- Low-air warning (vibe alert/whistle) while operating in an IDLH is considered an air emergency and requires immediate action. (Notification to Command and exiting the IDLH atmosphere intact as a crew).
- MAYDAY should be called if unable to leave IDLH atmosphere before exhausting emergency reserve of air supply.

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Policy: 608.08 Response to Power Lines/Energized Electrical Equipment

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It is our policy to respond to reports of power lines down and other hazards involving energized electrical equipment (transformers, substations, electric vaults) for fire control and public safety. It is the responsibility of the company officer to maintain that level of safety until relieved by another fire company, police agency or utility company.

This guideline will establish a standard approach and response to the report of power lines down and other responses to energized electrical equipment. Power lines can come in contact with the ground as a result of storm related activity, fire, or vehicles striking power poles. In all cases, the potential for electrical shock/electrocution and secondary fire must be considered.

ELECTRIC SAFETY AWARENESS

Electricity will travel any conductive path it can as it seeks a ground. A direct path to ground can occur when contact is made between something energized and a portion of your body such as your hand, arm, head or other body part. An indirect path to ground occurs when you are holding something or touching an object that is in contact with something energized. This could include tools or other equipment you may be holding or when touching a fence, vehicle, or other object that may be in contact with something energized.

Gradient Voltage (Step and Touch Potential): When power lines are down, they will energize the ground around them. For Example: point of ground contact could be 7160 volts. This voltage will lessen as it radiates out from this point; for example, 6000 volts. If your feet are in areas where there is a voltage difference, you could complete the circuit and be the source to ground. This is called "step potential". This danger could be indicated by a tingling sensation in the feet and serve as a warning to back away from the area. Step potential is more severe when the ground is wet.

KEY POINTS

1. Downed lines must always be considered energized with potentially lethal current.
2. Lines can reset and become "hot" or "energized" again by manual operation of a switch, by automatic re-closing methods (either method from short or long distances away), by induction where a de-energized line can become hot if it's near an energized line or through back feed conditions.
3. Power line tends to have "Reel Memory" and may curl back or roll on itself when down.
4. Use caution when spraying water on or around energized electrical equipment. Hose streams conduct current! Never spray directly into the power lines. Use a fog spray at the base of the pole. Your primary responsibility is to protect the surrounding area. Short bursts of water are preferred methods to avoid being grounded. Never spray water onto electrical equipment until a utility rep has confirmed that the equipment is de-energized or "dead."

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5. Electrical equipment is classified as:
 - a. Energized
 - b. De-energized (cannot be 100% guaranteed)
 - c. Dead (confirmed by utility representatives after grounding the lines(s).
6. PCB hazards: Smoke potentially fatal; avoid and contain pools of oil around transformers.
7. Poor soil resistance in the desert southwest may not provide enough of a ground to trip a circuit even when a conductor is laying on it.
8. You cannot tell the voltage of a power line by the size of the conductor. Most overhead conductors are not insulated
9. Voltage can travel through both dry and especially wet ground for considerable distances.
10. Pad-mounted and overhead transformers can explode.
11. Until grounded, equipment can contain electric potential, which can cause severe injury or death.
12. Electricity can flow through the ground or other conductive objects, (fences) to point far from the scene.

RESPONSE TO POWER LINES DOWN

1. Request utility company to respond.
2. Consider all down wires as “energized.”
3. Place apparatus away from “down lines and power poles” and out from under involved overhead lines that could fail and fall onto equipment or personnel.
4. Secure the area/deny entry.
5. Periods of high activity; company officer may choose to leave one (1) crewmember on-scene with a radio to wait for utility company.
6. In the event of multiple lines/poles down over a large area, call additional resources.

DOWN POWER LINES AND VEHICLES

1. Request utility company to respond.
2. Do not touch vehicle
3. Have occupants remain inside the vehicle
4. Place apparatus a safe distance away from down lines.
5. If occupants must leave the vehicle (fire or other threat to life) instruct them to open the door, not step-out! They should jump free of the vehicle without touching vehicle and ground at the same time; they should walk away from the vehicle with very small steps.

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SUB-STATION, TRANSFORMER, ELECTRICAL VAULT AND MANHOLE FIRE

1. Request utility company to respond.
2. Clear the area.
3. Be aware of explosion potential.
4. Place apparatus in a safe location away from overhead power lines.
5. Protect exposures.
6. Do not make entry until the utility representative has verified that the above electrical equipment has been de-energized. The utility representative may have to make entry to uninvolved sections to safely de-energize the equipment.

RESPONSE TO POWER POLE FIRES

1. Request utility company to respond.
2. Consider all wires and poles as “energized.”
3. Place apparatus away from “down lines and power poles” and out from under involved overhead lines that could fail and fall onto equipment or personnel.
4. Secure the area/deny entry.
5. Do not make any fire attack until the utility representative has verified that the electrical equipment has been de-energized.

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This policy establishes a standard structure and procedure for all fire department personnel operating at incidents involving water rescue operations. The policy outlines responsibilities for first-responders, Command Officers and other fire department personnel responding to such incidents.

PURPOSE

The purpose of this procedure is to establish guidelines for the response of fire department personnel and equipment to water rescue incidents. Because water rescue operations present a significant danger to fire department personnel, the safe and effective management of these operations require special considerations. This guideline identifies some of the critical issues that must be included in managing these incidents.

TACTICAL CONSIDERATIONS

Due to the inherent dangers associated with these operations, the Calimesa Fire Department Risk Management Profile shall be applied to all water rescue operations and shall be continuously reassessed throughout the incident. A phased approach to water rescue operations that include; Arrival, Pre-Rescue Operations, Rescue Operations and Termination can be utilized to safely and effectively mitigate these high-risk/low-frequency events.

PHASE I: ARRIVAL

A. ESTABLISH COMMAND

1. First arriving company officer shall assume Command and begin an immediate size- up of the situation.
2. First arriving Engine that is staffed with a Company Officer should be assigned Rescue Operations. The Company Officer assigned as the Rescue Operative should remain with his crew. Rescue Operations responsibilities include:
 - a. Assuming technical rescue operations control.
 - b. Identifying hazards and critical factors.
 - c. Developing a rescue plan and back-up plan.
 - d. Informing Command of conditions, actions, and needs during all phases of the Rescue Operation.
3. Designate a Safety Officer.

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B. SIZE-UP

1. Secure a witness to assist in gathering information to determine exactly what happened and the location of any victim(s). If no witnesses are present, Command may have to look for clues on the scene to determine what happened.
2. Assess the immediate and potential hazards to the rescuers.
3. Isolate immediate hazard area, secure the scene, and deny entry for all non-rescue personnel.
4. Assess on-scene capabilities and determine the need for additional resources.

PHASE II: PRE-RESCUE OPERATIONS

It must be determined if this will be a RESCUE operation or a RECOVERY operation based on the survivability profile of the victim(s) which include factors such as the location and condition of the victim(s), and elapsed time since the accident occurred.

A. MAKE THE GENERAL AREA SAFE

1. Establish a hazard zone perimeter.
2. Keep all non-essential rescue personnel out of the hazard zone.
3. Remove all non-essential civilian personnel at least 150 feet away from the hazard zone.

B. MAKE THE RESCUE AREA SAFE

All personnel operating at or near the water shall be in proper personal protective equipment (PPE) that will include at a minimum: personal flotation device (PFD), approved water rescue helmet, and approved footwear.

1. Identify hazards that are present which include but are not limited to:
 - a. The volume of water.
 - b. The velocity of the water.
 - c. Debris in the water.
 - d. Hydraulics.
 - e. Depth of the water – rising / falling.
2. Assign personnel upstream.
 - a. Rescue personnel shall be assigned upstream to advise of any upstream hazards that may effect the rescue operations
3. Assign personnel downstream.

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- a. Rescue personnel shall be assigned downstream with throw bags to capture rescue personnel or victim(s) that may be washed downstream.
4. Assemble all necessary personnel, equipment, and patient packaging equipment that will be required for the rescue operation.

PHASE III: RESCUE OPERATIONS

A. RESCUE SECTOR

1. Rescue responsibilities shall include the following:
 - a. Ensure that all personnel operating in the rescue are accounted for and wearing appropriate PPE.
 - b. Develop a rescue plan and a back-up plan.
 - c. Ensure the plan and back-up plan, which include emergency procedures, are communicated to all personnel operating on the incident.

B. THE RESCUE PLAN

Rescue operations should be conducted with as little risk to the rescuers as necessary to affect the rescue. Low-risk operations may not always be possible but should be considered first. The order of rescue from low-risk to high-risk are:

1. *TALK* – if water is calm or slow moving try to talk the victim into self-rescue if possible.
2. *REACH* – extend an arm, pike pole, rescue hook, or any other such object to reach the victim and pull from the water.
3. *THROW* – attempt to throw the victim(s) a throw-bag rescue line or some other type of approved safety flotation device and “pendulum-belay” or “haul” the victim(s) to the bank.
4. *ROW* - If it is determined that a boat-based operation shall be utilized. Rescue Sector shall assign a company on the opposite bank to assist in establishing an anchor for an approved rope system.
5. *GO* - If it is not possible to row to the victim, the Company Officer or Incident Commander should consider putting a rescuer or rescuers in the water to reach the victim. This is a very high-risk operation and shall be conducted exclusively by trained TRT personnel. Prior to entering the water, rescue personnel shall be briefed on the plan, the back-up plan and emergency procedures. Rescue personnel shall never be attached to a lifeline without the benefit of a quick-release mechanism approved for water rescue.

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Rescue personnel shall never do a “breath-hold” surface dive in an attempt to locate a victim beneath the surface of the water.

6. *HELO* - Helicopter operations are considered high-risk and shall be decided upon through consultation with Safety Command and the Technical Advisor.

C. ASSESS THE VICTIM

When the rescuers reach the victim a primary survey shall be completed. If the victim is conscious rescuers should determine if the victim can assist in the rescue. If the victim is unconscious the rescue must be completed as quickly as possible.

D. TREATMENT

1. Initiate C-spine precautions as soon as possible.
2. Conduct a secondary survey and correct any life threatening conditions.
3. Provide for ALS level treatment and transportation to a hospital as indicated.

PHASE IV: TERMINATION

- A. Ensure personnel accountability.
- B. Consider decontamination of victim(s) and rescuer(s).
- C. Recover all tools and equipment used in the rescue/recovery. In cases of a fatality consider leaving everything in place until the investigative process has been completed.
- D. Consider a Post Incident Critique (may be more appropriate at a later date).
- E. Return to service after returning all equipment to apparatus.

ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

I. COMMAND STRUCTURE

- A. The first arriving unit shall assume Command of the incident. This unit shall remain in Command until Command is transferred to improve the quality of the Command organization.

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- B. The first arriving Company Officer should be assigned Rescue. Rescue teams, Upstream, Downstream, and any other such functional team operating near the water shall be under the direction of the Incident Commander

II. OTHER CONSIDERATIONS

- A. Consider the effects of inclement weather and water conditions on the hazard profile, the victim(s), and the rescuers with particular attention to the effects of hypothermia.
- B. Water rescue incidents attract the news media; consider assigning a PIO.

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FOG GUIDE

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INCIDENT COMMAND SYSTEM PREFACE

INCIDENT COMMAND SYSTEM

I. PURPOSE

The Department responds to a wide range of emergency incidents. This directive identifies standard operating guidelines to be employed in establishing command. This allows for the effective management of personnel and resources providing for the safety and welfare of personnel. It establishes guidelines for the implementation of all components of the Incident Command System (ICS) for incident operations including:

- A. Fixing the responsibility for command of a specific individual through a standard system, depending on the arrival sequence of companies and chief officers.
- B. Establish an effective incident organization by defining the activities and responsibilities assigned to the Incident Commander and to other individuals operating within ICS.
- C. Provide a system to process information to support incident management, planning, and decision-making including command responsibility and modes of operations.

II. RESPONSIBILITY

All suppression personnel shall be completely familiar with the procedures outlined in this directive and be able to perform according to their position.

III. SCOPE

These procedures govern actions at all incidents requiring a command structure.

IV. GENERAL PROCEDURES

The general procedures outline the operating principles that establish the framework for emergency incident operations and command. The effective functioning of units and personnel at incidents requires clear decisive action on the part of an Incident Commander.

- A. The Incident Commander (IC) is responsible for the completion of the tactical priorities. The main tactical priorities are:
 - 1. Remove endangered occupants and treat the injured.
 - 2. Stabilize the incident and provide life safety.
 - 3. Conserve property.

4. Continuously provide for the safety, accountability, and welfare of all personnel.
- B. The Incident Commander is responsible for all functions of command including:
1. Assume and announce command and establish an effective operating position (Incident Command Post).
 2. Rapidly evaluate the situation (size up).
 3. Initiate, maintain, and control the communications process.
 4. Identify a clear and concise strategy that is easily understood by all personnel.
 5. Develop an Incident Action Plan (IAP) and assign companies and personnel consistent with plan and standard operating guidelines.
 6. Develop an effective ICS organization.
 7. Provide tactical objectives.
 8. Review, evaluate, and revise the Incident Action Plan as needed.
 9. Provide for the continuity, transfer, and termination of command.
 10. Ensure required reports are completed.
- C. The Incident Commander (IC) should begin to institute the Incident Command System (ICS) and appoint ICS positions whenever three (3) or more units are involved in an incident, or based on the following general factors
1. When the IC predicts the incident will involve a number of companies beyond the capability to directly control, or the IC cannot effectively manage the number of companies currently involved in the operation. In such cases, early recognition and delegation are essential.
 2. When companies are operating from tactical positions over which the IC has little control or are involved in complex operations.
- D. All subordinate ICS positions created by the IC shall be structured by the following guidelines:
1. The Incident Commander is responsible for building an ICS organization that matches the organizational needs of the incident to achieve tactical priorities.
 2. The number of companies assigned to an organizational position depends upon conditions within that assignment. Five companies represent the recommended maximum ICS span of control. The IC will maintain an awareness of the number of companies operating under an ICS position and the capability of the officer to effectively manage them.

3. ICS positions established at an incident shall be designated as outlined by FIREScope 420-1 and NIIMS. The most common positions are below, however any needed position can be established:
 - a. STAGING AREA- Geographical name (Example - 3rd Street Staging)
 - b. BRANCHES
 - (i) Numerical (Example - Branch 1)
 - (ii) Functional (Example - Medical Branch)
 - c. DIVISIONS
 - (i) Alphabetical (Example - Division A)
 - (ii) Geographical (Example-Roof Division)
 - (iii) Numerical (Multi-story by floor) (Example - Division 9)
 - (iiii) When assigning a division, boundaries and responsibilities shall be identified.
 - d. GROUPS

Functionally only, operates on the entire fire ground (Example - Rescue Group or Ventilation Group)
4. When establishing a Division/Group, the Incident Commander shall assign:
 - a. A supervisor (Position Officer).
 - b. Tactical objectives.
 - c. A radio designation (Roof Division, Division A).
 - d. The identity of resources assigned to the Division/Group.
5. ICS position officers shall use the assigned position designation in radio communications.
6. ICS positions can be filled by Chief Officers, Company Officers, or any other qualified department member designated by the IC.
7. The Division/Group Supervisor must be able to directly supervise and monitor operations in their Division/Group. The supervisor must keep the officer above them informed of the conditions, actions, and needs (CAN Report) within the division/group. The supervisor must ensure actions are consistent with the tactical objectives of the IC.

8. When an ICS position assignment is given to a company officer, the officer must utilize their personnel as aides, or assign them to operate under the leadership of another qualified company member.
9. When a company is assigned to an operating division/group, the company will be told the division/group they are assigned, where it is located, and to what officer to report. The ICS position officer will be informed of companies assigned.
10. Company officers will direct communications to their division/group supervisors and use plain text whenever possible.

V. INCIDENT PROCEDURES

General incident procedures are outlined in the attached appendices for the most common incident types. These guidelines also provide a framework for any incident type not listed.

Appendix A

STRUCTURAL FIREFIGHTING INCIDENT PROCEDURES

A. "Curbside" Report on Conditions

The person in charge of the first arriving unit shall transmit a "curb side" report on conditions on the assigned command channel including:

1. Unit identifier.
2. Building Description.
 - a. Occupancy (residential/ commercial/ single family/ multi-family).
 - b. Size (small, medium, large).
 - c. Arrangement (multi-story, garden style, etc.).
3. Obvious conditions (What is showing, smoke description, location).
4. Advise status of water supply.
5. Operating Mode – investigating, command, rescue, attack, protecting exposures (ICRAP)
6. Advise all units assigned to switch to the tactical channel for assignments
7. Example: "PERRIS, Calimesa Engine 1 is on scene of a large 2 story residential structure with heavy black turbulent smoke showing from the first story Alpha/Bravo corner. Calimesa Engine 1 has its own water supply and will be in the attack mode, have all units switch to the tactical frequency for assignments, standby for 360 report"

B. "360 Report"

The 360 report shall be given on the command frequency and acknowledged by the responding Battalion Chief. If a walk around 360 is unable to be completed due to extenuating circumstances (fences, animals, size of occupancy, etc.) this will be transmitted as an incomplete 360 due to the above circumstances. The 360 report should include the following:

1. Update on conditions, confirm fire location:
2. Rescue potential (if any exist).

3. Exposure potential (if any exist).
4. Life Hazards (if any exist) - Reported directly to responding BC with acknowledgment.
5. Designate A (Alpha) side.
6. Choose a Strategy (Offensive or Defensive) or update Mode of Operation.
7. Assume appropriate ICS position (IC, Fire Attack, Interior, Floor Division, Rescue Group, etc.).
8. Example: "All units enroute to the structure fire on 3rd Street, the 360 is complete and it appears we have a well involved fire in the Alpha/Bravo corner, the alpha side will be the address side, this will be an offensive strategy and Calimesa Engine 1 will be assuming fire attack transitioning the fire until a stand-by crew is in place."
Calimesa Battalion 1: "Calimesa Battalion 1 copies the 360 report."

Incomplete 360 Example: "All units responding to the structure fire on 3rd St, the 360 is incomplete due to a large dog to the rear of the structure but it does appear that we have a well involved fire in the Alpha/Bravo corner, the alpha side will be the address side, this will be an offensive strategy and Calimesa Engine 1 will be assuming fire attack transitioning the fire until a stand-by crew is in place."
Calimesa Battalion 1: "Calimesa Battalion 1 copies the 360 report."

C. Choosing a Mode of Operation

The individual in charge of the first arriving unit must decide on an appropriate commitment for their unit. This decision shall be stated as part of the "Curb Side" report but may be updated or changed after the "360 report". This will usually fall into one of three modes:

1. Investigating - these situations require investigation by the first arriving unit. The personnel will utilize their portable radio to communicate conditions while in the process of investigating the conditions. Command function will remain with the person in charge of the first arriving unit and all findings during the investigation shall be reported on the command channel. The responding Battalion Chief will then transmit the reported findings on the command channel to the dispatch center.

Example: "Perris, Calimesa Battalion 1 with Calimesa Engine 1 on scene reporting, small exterior fire, they can handle, cancel the remainder of the balance, cancel the clock and release the tactical frequency."

2. Attack - situations which require immediate action to stabilize the incident, such as small interior fires, require that the officer quickly decide how to commit the company. Where a rapid-fire attack is critical the individual in charge shall notify Dispatch of their action. Command function will remain with the person in charge of the first arriving unit until arrival of the second unit, and then command will transfer to that officer.
3. Command - situations that require primarily command actions. Incidents by their size, complexity, or potential, which require strong, direct, overall command from the outset. The person in charge of the first arriving unit will assume the command position and maintain that position until properly relieved. The person in charge of the first arriving unit will assign any remaining crew member as needed. Once command is established it shall be reported on both the command and tactical frequencies with the Incident Command Post (ICP) location.

Example: Command Channel: "Perris, Calimesa Battalion 1 is on scene assuming command as 3rd street IC, the command post will be located on the A/B corner of the structure."

D. Establishing Command

If the first arrive shall assume command and remain in command until relieved or the incident is terminated. If the second unit to arrive is a truck company and a third unit or officer is close behind, it is appropriate for command to pass to the third unit. This transfer must be clearly stated and understood by all units. The radio designation "IC" shall be used with a brief description of the incident location with reference to major building, street, or geographical location. This designation will not change through the duration of the incident. Once command has been established, all communications with dispatch should come from the IC or designee.

1. Assignment of responding units
 - a. All units responding to multiple unit responses shall follow standard responding and staging procedures. (Refer to Calimesa S.O.G. 605.05)
 - b. All units shall check in and receive an assignment from the IC prior to engaging in any operation at the scene.
2. Command Communications
 - a. "All Clear" is the term to be used to notify dispatch that a primary search has been completed.
 - b. "Under Control" indicates that the situation has been stabilized.

E. Transfer of Command

The transfer of command should follow these procedures:

1. Arriving officer assuming command will meet face-to-face when possible, with the officer being relieved and formally communicating the transfer via radio on the command and tactical frequencies.
2. The officer being relieved will brief the officer assuming command indicating the following:
 - a. General situation status

- b. Fire location, extent, conditions, and extension.
- c. Effectiveness of control efforts.
- d. Deployment and assignments of operating companies.
- e. Appraisal of needs for additional resources.



CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

FIRST-IN COMPANY OFFICER RESPONSIBILITIES

1. Size-Up

- ❖ Radio Report of Conditions
- ❖ Confirm Communication Plan

2. Alarm Assignment Response Status

Upgrade, continue or reduce alarm assignment

3. Select Mode of Operations

- a) Investigation
- b) Assume command
- c) Rescue mode
- d) Attack mode

4. Self-Assignment

- ❖ Division (Geographical)
- ❖ Group (Functional)
 - Self-Objectives

5. Apparatus Placement

6. Initial Actions

COMMAND TRANSFER / PROGRESS REPORT



❖ **Command Transfer**

- Current and planned situation
- Current resource assignments
- Current ICS organization
- Non-resourced priorities and Objectives
- New assignment once relieved

❖ **Progress / Exception Report**

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| ➤ Position | Conditions |
| ➤ Progress | Actions |
| ➤ Needs | Needs |